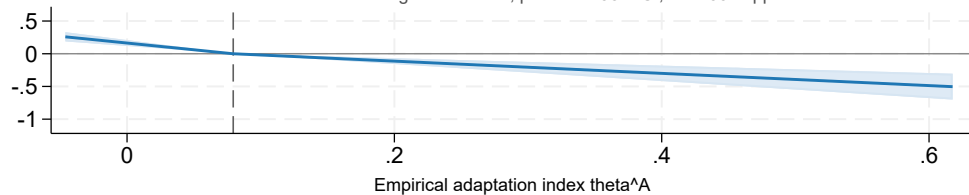


Debt/GDP change through t+2 without  $b_{it}$ 

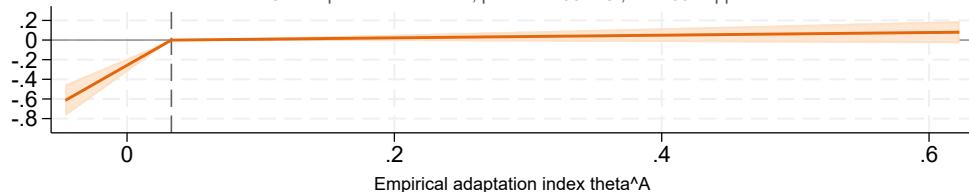
Full controls excluding current debt; pointwise 95% CI; P1-P99 support



Positive values imply a larger debt/GDP increase; dashed line: re-estimated debt cutoff.

## Readiness at t+1 without lagged A

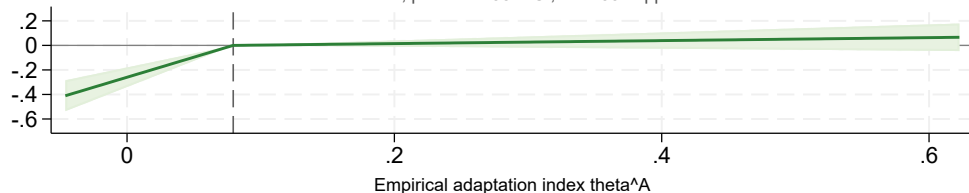
Own-equation RSS cutoff; pointwise 95% CI; P1-P99 support



Positive values imply higher readiness; dashed line: readiness-equation RSS cutoff.

## No-lag readiness at no-b debt cutoff

A at t+1; pointwise 95% CI; P1-P99 support



Dashed line: cutoff minimizing RSS in the no-b full debt equation.